

— COMPLETE COMBINED EDITION —

OBSERVE
ANALYSE
PREDICT
ADAPT
OUTPLAY

READ THE PLAYER

SAME
PLAYERS.
DIFFERENT
MINDS.
THAT'S
THE EDGE.

The Psychology of Outsmarting Online Opponents

How to Read Behaviour, Predict Decisions,
Control Fights & Build Elite Game Sense

*Same patterns...
Different result?
Bait?
Timing...
He'll peek here...
Patience wins.*

BETTER
PLAYERS
THINK
FURTHER

ROTATE?

HOLD?

PUSH?

- ☒ POSITIONING
- ☒ TIMING
- ☒ HABITS
- ☒ MINDSET
- ☒ PREDICTION
- ☒ ADVANTAGE



INFORMATION
PATTERN
INTENTION
PRESSURE
DECISION
REACTION

PEOPLE

PATTERNS

PRESSURE

PERSPECTIVE

PROGRESS

A
CALMER
MIND
WINS
MORE

SUPUN "HANZO" HASANKA

GAMES ARE WON IN THE MIND

Author's Note - Why I Wrote This

My name is Supun "Hanzo" Hasanka. I have been a competitive gamer for the last eight years, and this book is what I learned from spending thousands of hours against real people in multiplayer games.

Why am I writing this? Because across the games I played, I kept hearing the same thing from teammates and opponents: "Hanzo, you are good at game sense." For a long time, I did not think of it as a special skill. I thought I was simply paying attention.

One moment changed how I understood it. A manager from my VALORANT team once asked me, "Hanzo, do you know who has the best game sense in our team?" I answered, "Probably not me." He told me, "You do not know your capacity. You are the best game-sense player I have ever met." That comment made me look back at what I was actually doing during matches.

There were rounds where I would tell teammates, "Okay, this player is coming now. Three, two, one..." and then the player would appear. Boom - the kill. I could often predict which site an opponent wanted to plant, which route they were likely to use, or which angle I should hold before I had direct visual confirmation. It was not magic, and it was not certainty. It was a prediction built from timing, repetition, map geometry, pressure, economy, player personality and the information from previous rounds.

I noticed the same process in Call of Duty 4, VALORANT, Special Force 2, League of Legends, CS:GO, CS2, Overwatch, Apex Legends, PUBG, Fortnite and other multiplayer games. I played many maps as a sniper. That role forced me to understand time. How many seconds does it take an enemy to reach a location? If I arrive at my angle at this second, could anybody already be there? If someone is missing, which path gives them enough time to appear behind us? Which place should my crosshair already be looking at?

Game sense is not seeing the future. It is building the most accurate model of what another human is likely to do next.

There is also an important limit: game sense alone does not guarantee a win. Competitive games are systems. Teamwork, communication, mechanics, utility, economy, roles, emotional control and team synchronization matter. A brilliant read that your team cannot act on may still lose the round. But strong game sense massively increases the quality of the decisions you and your team make.

This book does not claim that I am 100% correct. I make mistakes too, and I learn from them. I am not a professional book writer, but I have done my best to share what I have learned from my own experience. I hope you find something useful here, learn something new, and develop your own way of understanding the game.

As I worked on this book, I realized I wanted to take these ideas further than just the page. My long-term goal is to build an AI-powered coaching system that can analyze gameplay, identify important decision moments, track repeated habits, and help players understand why certain choices worked or failed. The idea is not to let AI play the game for you, but to use it as a learning tool that helps you improve your own game sense, awareness, timing, and decision-making. This book is the foundation of that vision, and the same principles I share here will guide the AI system we are currently developing. ([Link](#))

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THE CORE PROMISE OF THIS BOOK

This book will not teach you to "guess harder." It will teach you how to observe, form hypotheses, assign probabilities, test those hypotheses, notice psychological changes, and update your model of the opponent.

What This Book Promises

This book does not promise a 100%-win rate. It is designed to help you win more rounds, make better decisions, improve the quality of your KDA through smarter fights, and learn how to think about opponents the way experienced players do.

Everything here comes from my personal experience of reading players across different multiplayer games. I will show you how I use timing, mistakes, ego, confidence, fear, habits, economy, map movement and team behavior to build a picture of the person behind the character.

You can copy my process, but do not stop there. Build your own way of reading the game. Question the theory, test it, question the result, update your thinking, and repeat. This is a general game-sense guide rather than a guide for one specific title. Game-specific guides can go deeper later.

The purpose is not to tell you what to believe. The purpose is to train you to observe more carefully and ask better questions. GLHF <3

How to Use This Book

Do not read this like a collection of tricks. Read it as a training manual for thinking. Each chapter asks you to notice a different layer of human behavior. Your goal is to become a better observer before you become a better predictor.

- Use the examples as models, not fixed rules. A timing that is correct on one map, rank or patch may be wrong on another.
- Never treat one action as proof of a personality. Look for repeated evidence.
- When you make a prediction, ask what evidence supports it and what evidence could disprove it.
- Review both your correct and incorrect reads. Correct reads can be lucky; incorrect reads can still be logically sound.
- Study high-ELO players by asking why they act at a particular moment, not by copying the action without context.

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PART I - THE PSYCHOLOGY BEHIND GAME SENSE

1.1. You Are Playing a Human, not a Character Model

A multiplayer opponent is not a random object. They are a decision-maker with goals, habits, emotions, limited attention and incomplete information. Every action you see is the output of an internal process: they noticed something, interpreted it, selected an action and accepted a risk.

If you only react to the final action - the peek, the push, the rotation - you are always one step late. Psychological game sense tries to reconstruct the decision before it becomes visible.

THE DECISION CHAIN

Stimulus -> Interpretation -> Expectation -> Risk calculation -> Action -> Result -> Emotional update -> Next decision

Example: a CS2 rifler hears one flash and two sets of footsteps at Banana. A beginner sees the later retreat and thinks "he backed off." A deeper read asks: Did he retreat because he fears a rush? Did he expect utility? Is he preserving a rifle? Is he trying to pull a teammate? Does his team commonly re-peek after the first utility wave? The same movement can come from different psychological causes.

1.2. Prediction Is Bayesian, Even If You Never Use the Word

Strong game sense behaves like informal Bayesian reasoning: you begin with a prior belief, receive evidence, and update the probability of different explanations. You do not need equations during a match. You need the habit of updating rather than locking onto your first idea.

Example - The Repeating A-Ramp Player

SITUATION

In three consecutive VALORANT attack rounds, one opponent appears at A Ramp between 1:32 and 1:28. In round four, you have not seen them yet.

What to read: The repeated route, repeated timing, team default and whether the player had success there.

Psychology underneath it: Success creates reinforcement. If the route produced space or kills, the player has a psychological reason to repeat it until punished.

Counter-plan: Hold a position that punishes the likely timing while keeping an escape. Do not stack the entire team solely because of one player's pattern.

Common mistake: Treating "three times" as certainty. A good opponent may know they have shown the pattern and deliberately break it.

1.3. Habits, Preferences and States Are Different

A habit is repeated behavior over time. A preference is an option a player chooses more often when multiple choices are available. A state is temporary behavior caused by the current situation - for example, low confidence after losing three duels. Confusing these leads to bad reads.

THREE LAYERS

Habit: "This player often lurks."

Preference: "When lurking, they prefer mid."

State: "After being caught twice, they are now unusually cautious."

The most useful psychological question is not "What type of player is this?" It is "What type of player are they being right now, and what changed?"

1.4. Reward Reinforcement: Why Players Repeat What Works

People naturally repeat actions that produce rewards. In games, a reward can be a kill, space, a successful plant, a clean escape, praise from teammates or simply the feeling of control. This is why early rounds reveal so much. If an opponent wins the same duel twice, they become more likely to believe that duel belongs to them.

That confidence can be used against them. The correct counter is not always to fight harder. Sometimes you deliberately make the route look available, then change your position or timing so their reinforced expectation leads them into a prepared response.

BEFORE YOU TRY TO READ PEOPLE

What You Need Before Game Sense

You can predict the opponent perfectly and still be unable to convert the read. Game sense multiplies your existing fundamentals; it does not replace them.

- Good aim - not necessarily the best aim in the lobby, but enough mechanical control to punish the opportunity your read creates.
- Map awareness - you need to understand routes, sightlines, objectives, travel time and which locations are realistically possible.
- Utility knowledge - know what abilities, grenades, cooldowns or resources can change a fight and when they are available.
- Team communication - when possible, turn your read into a short call your teammates can act on. In solo queue, communicate useful information even if others are quiet.

Your Two Best Friends: Mistakes and Ego

Every player makes mistakes. Even professional players make them. A mistake is not only an error to punish; it is evidence about how the player thinks. Ego is equally useful because it changes risk tolerance. A player who feels they must prove something often gives you a more predictable next action.

The goal is not to insult the opponent or assume they are stupid. The goal is to notice when emotion, habit or confidence reduces the number of choices they are likely to make.

PART I-A - THE 30 HUMAN BEHAVIOURS BEHIND EVERY PLAYER

These are not permanent personality diagnoses. A single player can move between several behaviors in one match. Treat each type as a temporary behavioral pattern: observe it, test it, and update when the evidence changes. The behaviors in this section are patterns I have personally identified through nine years of competitive gaming experience.

Core rule: do not say “he is an ego player” after one peek. Say “after losing the duel, he has re-peeked twice with less support; ego or revenge may be influencing his decision.” Specific evidence is stronger than labels.

1.A.1. The Ego Player

Psychological drive: Wants to prove mechanical superiority and often treats backing away as losing status.

Typical tells:

- Re-peeks after losing a duel.
- Takes unnecessary 1v1s.
- Chases the same opponent after being challenged.
- May ignore the objective to recover pride.

Common mistake: Fighting when there is no strategic reason.

How to read them: After a challenge or embarrassing death, watch whether the player returns to the same duel faster or with extra utility.

How to counter: Give them the fight they want from a different timing, angle or crossfire. Do not mirror their ego.

Example: VALORANT: Reyna loses an A-Main duel, then next round dismisses utility support and swings the same lane earlier. Instead of re-taking the same 50/50, hold an off-angle with a teammate ready to trade.

1.A.2. The Revenge Player

Psychological drive: Becomes emotionally attached to killing the opponent who just beat them.

Typical tells:

- Changes route to find the same player.
- Uses disproportionate utility on one area.
- Pushes faster after an embarrassing death.

Common mistake: Stops playing the round and starts playing the person.

How to read them: After you kill them, immediately ask: “Would they spend the next round trying to find me?” Watch path and utility commitment.

How to counter: Reposition after the kill. Let them attack your old location while you create a new problem.

Example: CS2: after dying twice to your AWP on Long, the rifle buys utility specifically to flush Long next round. You change to a secondary angle and punish the commitment.

1.A.3. The Tilted Player

Psychological drive: Emotion reduces their decision quality and compresses their choice set.

Typical tells:

- Rushes decisions.
- Over-peeks.
- Stops coordinating.
- Repeats emotionally satisfying plays.

Common mistake: Becomes predictable because frustration replaces calculation.

How to read them: Look for a sudden change from their normal pace after several bad rounds.

How to counter: Stay patient. Do not join the emotional tempo. Let them create unnecessary risk.

Example: A normally disciplined anchor starts pushing every round after losing three clutches. Hold the push rather than forcing an execute into it.

1.A.4. The Fearful Player

Psychological drive: Prior punishment raises perceived danger and makes the player avoid risk.

Typical tells:

- Gives up space.
- Holds deeper angles.
- Rotates late.
- Avoids previously dangerous lanes.

Common mistake: Surrenders map control because memory of punishment dominates the current round.

How to read them: Notice which zones they stop testing after being punished.

How to counter: Pressure the zone enough to keep the fear alive, then use the free space elsewhere without overcommitting.

Example: After being Operator-picked twice at B Long, an attacker stops challenging it completely. You can sometimes use that psychological space to reposition.

1.A.5. The Overconfident Player

Psychological drive: Success lowers their perception of risk.

Typical tells:

- Repeats successful peeks.
- Uses less utility after winning duels.
- Pushes deeper.
- Takes wider swings.

Common mistake: Confuses previous success with future safety.

How to read them: After two or three wins, watch whether their support, clearing or patience decreases.

How to counter: Allow the familiar picture to appear, then punish the repeat with a changed setup.

Example: Reyna wins two openings, then starts dry swinging because she believes the lane belongs to her. A delayed flash + crossfire turns confidence into a trap.

1.A.6. The Habit Player

Psychological drive: Uses repetition to reduce cognitive effort.

Typical tells:

- Same route.
- Same timing.
- Same hold.
- Same rotation trigger.

Common mistake: Does not notice how much information repeated routine gives away.

How to read them: Track frequency over several rounds instead of reacting to one example.

How to counter: Punish only after the pattern is strong enough, then expect adaptation.

Example: A B anchor rotates at the first A flash three rounds in a row. On the fourth, show the same cue and leave a lurker to catch the rotation.

1.A.7. The Comfort-Zone Player

Psychological drive: Prefers familiar weapons, positions and problems where they feel competent.

Typical tells:

- Returns to the same site or angle.
- Buys the same weapon when possible.
- Looks uncomfortable after being displaced.

Common mistake: Performance drops when forced into unfamiliar geometry or responsibility.

How to read them: Ask where the player looks most relaxed and where they avoid playing.

How to counter: Remove the preferred fight and force them to solve a different problem.

Example: An AWP player dominates long sightlines but becomes ordinary in close retakes. Smoke the lane and force short-range decisions.

1.A.8. The Impatient Player

Psychological drive: Experiences silence as pressure and wants to create action.

Typical tells:

Pushes after long quiet periods.

Peeks because "nothing is happening."

Rotates before confirmation.

Common mistake: Creates a fight simply to escape uncertainty.

How to read them: Record how long the player tolerates inactivity before acting.

How to counter: Use silence as bait. Hold the likely impatience timing rather than revealing yourself early.

Example: In CS2, a CT pushes B after ~20 seconds of no contact in several rounds. A default can wait for the exact push window.

1.A.9. The Panic Player

Psychological drive: Under time or threat pressure, working memory narrows and familiar actions dominate.

Typical tells:

- Rushes plant/defuse.
- Misses corners.
- Uses utility poorly.
- Chooses shortest path.

Common mistake: Defaults to the most familiar action even when a better option exists.

How to read them: Identify what the player does when the clock becomes critical.

How to counter: Force them to spend time and make multiple decisions instead of giving a clean duel.

Example: With 15 seconds left, an attacker repeatedly takes the shortest route to plant. Hold a position that forces one extra clear and burns the clock.

1.A.10. The Greedy Player

Psychological drive: Values the extra kill or reward more than preserving an already winning position.

Typical tells:

- Chases low-health enemies.
- Overextends after first kill.
- Leaves tradeable positions.

Common mistake: Turns an advantage into unnecessary risk.

How to read them: After they gain an advantage, watch whether they continue moving forward instead of resetting.

How to counter: Show them a tempting escape path and punish the chase.

Example: You are 2v1. Instead of standing still after taking damage, retreat toward your teammate and let the greedy pursuer walk into a crossfire.

1.A.11. The Hero Player

Psychological drive: Wants to be the person who solves the round.

Typical tells:

- Solo flanks.
- Forces clutches.
- Takes high-impact risks when the team is losing.

Common mistake: Ignores team structure to search for a highlight or rescue play.

How to read them: When their team is behind, ask who repeatedly tries to make the dramatic move.

How to counter: Expect the flank or solo timing and deny isolated fights.

Example: A player who has tried two late flanks may do it again when their team is down 3v5. Keep one player disciplined on the timing.

1.A.12. The Safe Player

Psychological drive: Priorities survival and low variance.

Typical tells:

- Chooses cover-heavy routes.
- Rarely initiates.
- Saves early.
- Avoids uncertain fights.

Common mistake: Becomes predictable because “safest” options are often limited.

How to read them: Ask what location feels safest given the current information.

How to counter: Pressure the safe option or use it to predict their retreat.

Example: In a 1v1, a player repeatedly falls back to the strongest post-plant corner. Clear that position based on preference, not certainty.

1.A.13. The Copycat Player

Psychological drive: Copies actions seen from pros, teammates or guides without always understanding the condition that made them correct.

Typical tells:

- Uses recognizable setups.
- Repeats fashionable plays.
- Executes tactic even when supporting information is missing.

Common mistake: Copies the surface but not the reason.

How to read them: Look for a play that appears rehearsed but disconnected from current teammates, economy or timing.

How to counter: Punish the missing condition rather than the tactic itself.

Example: A player copies a pro lurks but their team creates no opposite-site pressure. The lurk becomes a slow isolated walk instead of attention manipulation.

1.A.14. The Reaction Player

Psychological drive: Lets external events determine their decisions rather than shaping the round.

Typical tells:

- Rotates on first cue.
- Uses utility only after contact.
- Rarely creates proactive pressure.

Common mistake: Easy to manipulate because the input-to-reaction relationship is consistent.

How to read them: Test them with small pieces of information and record the response.

How to counter: Feed controlled information, then attack the space their reaction leaves.

Example: Show two sets of footsteps and one flash A; if the B anchor always moves, the response becomes exploitable.

1.A.15. The Overthinker

Psychological drive: Keeps generating possibilities until decision confidence collapses.

Typical tells:

- Hesitates.
- Changes plans repeatedly.
- Second-guesses a correct first read.

Common mistake: Analysis paralysis makes timing late.

How to read them: Watch for players who repeatedly stop, turn, re-clear and arrive after the important window.

How to counter: Increase decision speed and ambiguity so they cannot comfortably model everything.

Example: Late in a round, quick coordinated pressure can force the overthinker to choose before they finish processing every possibility.

1.A.16. The Tunnel-Vision Player

Psychological drive: Attention locks onto one enemy, angle or task.

Typical tells:

- Chases one target.
- Misses flank.
- Ignores second contact.
- Over-focuses objective.

Common mistake: Working attention becomes too narrow.

How to read them: Notice what stimulus repeatedly captures them.

How to counter: Create a second threat while the first occupies attention.

Example: One teammate fight from site while you delay half a second and swing from another angle, attacking the player's attentional bottleneck.

1.A.17. The Pattern Breaker

Psychological drive: Actively avoids being readable and changes route, pace or aggression.

Typical tells:

- Different openings.
- Varied timing.
- Deliberate anti-pattern behavior.

Common mistake: Can become random without strategic purpose.

How to read them: Do not chase habits that are not there. Read objective constraints, economy and available zones.

How to counter: Counter the necessities of the round rather than the player's history.

Example: If a player varies every opening, late-round time and objective pressure may still force them into a small number of paths.

1.A.18. The Adaptive Player

Psychological drive: Updates quickly after being punished.

Typical tells:

- Changes setup after one failure.
- Stops repeating a read.
- Uses your counter as new information.

Common mistake: The main danger is that your old model becomes stale.

How to read them: Track adaptation speed itself: how many punishments before they change?

How to counter: Plan the second counter before using the first.

Example: After you punish a fast A peek once, expect the next round to contain a delayed peek, utility support or route change instead of camping the old timing.

1.A.19. The Lurker

Psychological drive: Values timing, isolation, information and attention manipulation.

Typical tells:

- Appears after main pressure.
- Holds rotation paths.
- Stays silent longer than expected.

Common mistake: Becomes predictable if their entry timing always depends on teammate contact.

How to read them: Ask when the player enters the round and what event normally activates them.

How to counter: Delay your rotation or leave controlled flank information so the lurker cannot rely on the same timing.

Example: Four attackers pressure A; the lurker waits B until defenders rotate. Their real weapon is the belief that B is empty.

1.A.20. The Information-Seeking Player

Psychological drive: Peeks to reduce uncertainty, not always to fight.

Typical tells:

- Jiggles.
- Shoulder peeks.
- Probes with utility.
- Disengages after seeing enough.

Common mistake: Can expose themselves while collecting information.

How to read them: Ask whether the movement is designed to kill or simply confirm presence.

How to counter: Give misleading but controlled information or punish repeated probe timing.

Example: A defender shoulder-peeks every ten seconds to check A Main. Hold the information timing rather than revealing yourself during the first probe.

1.A.21. The Dominance Player

Psychological drive: Wants ownership of a zone and wants the enemy to respect their presence.

Typical tells:

- Repeated early pressure.
- Deep pushes after success.
- Reclaims same area after being challenged.

Common mistake: Overcommits to preserve psychological control.

How to read them: Watch for a player who treats a specific area as personal territory.

How to counter: Let them believe they still own it, then change the punishment setup.

Example: A player repeatedly pushes Mid because nobody contests them. Instead of ego-peeking, give space and prepare a utility trap deeper.

1.A.22. The Frustrated Player

Psychological drive: Repeated failure creates urgency to force a result.

Typical tells:

- Speeds up.
- Forces fights.
- Abandons structured setup.

Common mistake: Replaces process with “something has to work.”

How to read them: Compare current tempo to their earlier disciplined baseline.

How to counter: Stay structured and let the forced action arrive.

Example: After three failed site hits, attackers may suddenly rush without the utility discipline they showed earlier.

1.A.23. The Momentum Player

Psychological drive: Success increases confidence and willingness to take initiative.

Typical tells:

- Earlier peeks.
- More aggressive pathing.
- Faster decisions after wins.

Common mistake: Risk tolerance rises beyond what the position justifies.

How to read them: After a streak of wins, expect an ambitious play that would have looked too risky earlier.

How to counter: Use a disciplined setup when their confidence is highest.

Example: An entry player with three opening kills begins taking the duel before support arrives. The next round is the ideal time to punish the shortened spacing.

1.A.24. The Low-Confidence Player

Psychological drive: Uncertainty and previous failure make them unwilling to commit.

Typical tells:

- Hesitates.
- Gives up angles.
- Waits for teammates.

- Avoids first contact.

Common mistake: Allows the opponent to dictate tempo.

How to read them: Watch who becomes slower after losing duels.

How to counter: Pressure their decision space, but do not overextend into teammates.

Example: A defender repeatedly gives site after early utility. Use that knowledge to take space cheaply, then prepare for the retake rather than chasing.

1.A.25. The Resource-Hoarder

Psychological drive: Overvalues future utility, credits, cooldowns or consumables.

Typical tells:

- Dies with abilities.
- Saves grenades too long.
- Avoids using expensive resources in uncertain situations.

Common mistake: Preserves resources until the round no longer gives time to use them.

How to read them: Track whether key utility is still unused late.

How to counter: Create early pressure that forces a meaningful use-or-lose decision.

Example: A controller repeatedly saves the final smoke until after attackers are already on site. Fast pressure can exploit the delay.

1.A.26. The Spend-Everything Player

Psychological drive: Uses resources immediately to feel safe or seize early control.

Typical tells:

- Dumps utility on first sound.
- Overreacts to early pressure.
- Has little left late.

Common mistake: The late round becomes weak because the early response was too expensive.

How to read them: Record what cue triggers the utility dump.

How to counter: Bait the trigger, reset, then attack after the resource window closes.

Example: Show early A presence, draw multiple grenades/smokes, then leave before committing and return later.

1.A.27. The Fake-Confidence Player

Psychological drive: Uses aggression to project strength but is not comfortable when challenged seriously.

Typical tells:

- Fast first step followed by immediate retreat.
- Loud pressure without deep commitment.
- Avoids second contact.

Common mistake: The performance of confidence collapses under resistance.

How to read them: Test whether their aggression continues when you hold ground.

How to counter: Call the bluff carefully: contest with support and see whether they retreat.

Example: A player repeatedly stomps forward to make noise but falls back as soon as utility lands. That may be pressure theatre rather than a real execute.

1.A.28. The Predictable Rotator

Psychological drive: Has a low information threshold and fears being late.

Typical tells:

- Moves on first sound cue.
- Leaves anchor space early.
- Trusts teammates immediately.

Common mistake: Overreacts and opens the opposite side.

How to read them: Determine the smallest cue that triggers the move.

How to counter: Fake exactly to that threshold, then exploit the emptied zone.

Example: If the B anchor leaves on three-player A noise without seeing spike, show the same picture and hold B access.

1.A.29. The Delayed Rotator

Psychological drive: Requires confirmation before committing to a rotation.

Typical tells:

- Stays anchored despite heavy noise.
- Waits for objective sighting or teammate certainty.

Common mistake: Can arrive too late against decisive executes.

How to read them: Test how much evidence they need before moving.

How to counter: Once confirmed, execute quickly enough that their discipline becomes lateness.

Example: If they refuse to rotate without spike confirmation, a fast committed hit can overwhelm the site before help arrives.

1.A.30. The Clutch-Mindset Player

Psychological drive: Becomes calmer and more structured when the round simplifies.

Typical tells:

- Slows down in 1vX.
- Uses sound carefully.
- Looks for isolated 1v1s.
- Manages time well.

Common mistake: The opponent team often helps them by taking solo fights.

How to read them: Notice whether their decision quality improves when fewer players remain.

How to counter: Do not feed isolation. Hold tradeable positions and make them solve multiple threats at once.

Example: Against a strong 1v2 player, avoid hunting from opposite sides at different times. Pair the final contact so one duel cannot become two separate duels.

The deeper lesson is that you are not reading a fixed "type." You are reading a changing combination of ego, fear, confidence, impatience, habit, attention, pressure and adaptation.

The same opponent can be an Ego Player in round 3, a Fearful Player in round 8, and an Adaptive Player in round 12.

PART II - OBSERVATION: BUILDING A PLAYER MODEL

2.1. The First Four Rounds: Information Before Ego

In tactical shooters such as VALORANT and CS2, the first few rounds can be treated as a scouting phase. This does NOT mean intentionally throwing rounds. You still play to win. The psychological shift is that you do not become frustrated if an early round is lost while it gives you high-quality information.

If you lose the first three or four rounds, ask whether you actually learned anything. Which player takes first contact? Who follows the entry? Who lurks? Who rotates early? Who refuses to rotate without confirmation? At what timestamp does pressure arrive? Which player changes behavior after being punished?

HANZO EARLY-ROUND RULE

A lost round with no learning is expensive. A lost round that exposes four repeatable tendencies can become an investment - if you actually use the information later.

Round-by-Round Observation Example

Round	Observed	Timing	Possible meaning	Confidence	Next test
1	Jett dry peeks A Main	1:35	Wants early duel / trusts aim	Low	Show presence, do not re-peek
2	Same Jett peeks after flash	1:33	Pattern may be role-driven	Medium	Change off-angle
3	Jett repeats after winning twice	1:34	Confidence reinforced	High	Punish with crossfire/utility
4	No Jett; late mid contact	1:10	They adapted after punishment	Medium	Update model; stop waiting forever

Notice what the table does psychologically: it separates observation from interpretation. "Jett peeks at 1:35" is evidence. "Jett is an ego-peeker" is an interpretation. Keeping those separate reduces confirmation bias.

Hanzo Field Example - Cypher on Bind

When I play Cypher on Bind, I often begin by treating the opening rounds as information collection while still trying to win. I can set up around B, stay near Elbow, use the camera, and watch both the immediate site and the minimap.

- Which enemy agents appear first, and at what time?
- Who appears together and who is separated from the group?
- Who gets the opening kill, and was it a clean headshot or a messy trade?
- Who is normally the entry player, and do they enter alone or only after utility/support?
- Which abilities were used, which are still available, and what does that say about the planned hit?
- Who repeatedly dies first? Who repeatedly survives late?

- When pressure goes A, does someone remain B or Mid to lurk?
- When I flank, where are the traps and which corners are actually being watched?
- If the attack stalls, do they continue pushing, reset, rotate or wait for a defender mistake?

I repeat this observation for several rounds. If a prediction is correct, confidence rises, but I still test it. If it is wrong, I do not force the theory; I watch another two or three rounds and ask what variable I missed. In familiar situations I may feel extremely confident in a read, but it remains a probability, never 100% confirmation.

MOBA Example - Reading Lane Psychology in League of Legends

The same process works outside tactical shooters. When I play mid in League of Legends with champions such as Akali, Zed or Yasuo, the reading starts before the first trade.

- Why did the opponent pick this champion - comfort, counter-pick, team composition, or lane pressure?
- What summoner spells and runes did they choose, and what risk profile do those choices encourage?
- What is the first item: Doran's Ring, Doran's Shield, Dark Seal or another option? What does that suggest about aggression, sustain or confidence?
- Which ability did they level first, and does it show an intention to punish, farm safely or create early pressure?

Do they prioritize last-hitting or repeatedly sacrifice farm to poke me?

After a failed trade, do they immediately try again, back away, wait for cooldowns, or call for jungle help?

Do not over-diagnose from one choice. For example, leveling a punishing ability can be matchup logic rather than ego. The useful read comes from combining the build choice with repeated behavior: if the player continuously sacrifices farm to force trades and then re-engages after losing one, the evidence for aggression or ego becomes stronger.

2.2. What to Record About an Opponent

- First-contact preference: who wants the first duel and on which side?
- Tempo: do they act instantly, after a short delay, or only after teammates create pressure?
- Risk tolerance: do they take 50/50 fights when they do not need to?
- Repetition: what do they repeat after success? What do they abandon after failure?
- Recovery behavior: after taking damage, do they retreat, re-peek, wait for help or reposition?
- Information threshold: how much evidence do they need before rotating?
- Team dependency: do they only become aggressive when utility or teammates support them?
- Clutch behavior: do they speed up under pressure or become extremely slow?
- Economy behavior: do they force-buy emotionally, save patiently or prefer particular weapons?
- Adaptation speed: how many times can you punish a pattern before they change it?

2.3. The Difference Between Reading and Stereotyping

Calling someone "aggressive" is useful only if you attach conditions. A player may be aggressive on pistol rounds, passive when carrying an Operator, and extremely cautious in a 1v2. Behavior is context-sensitive.

A strong read sounds like this: "When this player has a rifle and teammate utility, they challenge A Main within the first eight seconds. When they lose the opening duel, the next round they usually wait for a flash before re-engaging." That is specific enough to test.

PART III - TIMING, SPACE AND PREDICTIVE WINDOWS

3.1. Timing Is Invisible Positioning

Players think positioning means where someone stands. But timing determines which positions are even possible. If you know the minimum travel time between locations, you can eliminate impossible states and shrink uncertainty.

Sniper players often develop this naturally. If you know that an enemy needs approximately X seconds to reach an angle from spawn, you can decide whether an early sightline is safe, contested or already dangerous. The point is not memorizing one universal number; it is building timing anchors for each map.

TIMING ANCHORS

- Spawn-to-first contact.
- First contact-to-rotation.
- Plant-to-common-retake position.
- Noise cue-to-possible flank.
- Utility cue-to-entry window.

3.2. Arrival Windows, Not Exact Seconds

Human execution varies. Players hesitate, clear corners, get body-blocked, use utility or take fights. Therefore, think in windows: "This player can realistically appear between 1:34 and 1:30," not "they will appear at exactly 1:32."

Example - Sniper Timing Window

SITUATION

You are holding a long lane at round start. From previous rounds, the enemy's fastest contact appeared at 1:36 and their normal contact around 1:33.

What to read: Whether they use movement utility, whether someone else makes noise first, and whether the opponent has been punished for fast contact.

Psychology underneath it: The opponent is balancing reward (early space / duel) against anticipated punishment. After a successful fast peek, confidence often narrows their risk perception.

Counter-plan: Hold the earliest plausible timing with discipline, then change your focus after the window closes. Do not stare at the angle for 30 seconds just because they appeared there once.

Common mistake: Anchoring to one historical timing after the opponent has clearly changed pace.

3.3. Why Delay Is Information

When a usually fast player is late, the absence itself can be evidence. They may be using utility, waiting for teammates, changing route, expecting your counter, or setting up a lurk. Missing timing should trigger questions, not immediate conclusions.

A player arriving late is not “nothing happened.” The lateness is a behavioral event.

PART IV - FPS ROUND PSYCHOLOGY: VALORANT AND CS2

4.1. The Round Has Psychological Phases

A tactical FPS round changes psychologically as information, utility, economy and time change. The same player may behave differently in each phase.

ROUND PHASES

Opening: identity and confidence show up.
Mid-round: information processing and adaptation dominate.
Late round: time pressure exposes habits.
Post-plant/retake: role clarity, risk tolerance and teamwork are tested.

4.2. Opening Psychology - Who Wants Ownership?

Watch who repeatedly tries to establish ownership of a zone. The entry player is not merely “going first.” They may be testing whether your team respects their presence. If they win twice, they may begin taking more space with less support because confidence has increased.

VALORANT Example - Confident Reyna

SITUATION

Reyna wins two opening duels at A Main and begins appearing earlier each round.

What to read: Earlier timing, reduced utility support, wider swing, teammate spacing behind her.

Psychology underneath it: Repeated success creates overconfidence and a belief that you are scared of the duel. The player may unconsciously lower the amount of evidence needed to commit.

Counter-plan: Do not feed the same duel. Give a slightly different visual picture: off-angle, double contact, delayed utility, or fall back and re-fight with numbers.

Common mistake: Trying to “prove” you can out-aim her by repeating the exact duel.

4.3. Mid-Round Psychology - What Do They Believe?

Mid-round decisions are driven by beliefs about where defenders are, how quickly they rotate, which utility remains and how much map control exists. Your job is to understand the belief behind the move.

If attackers repeatedly fake pressure and your team instantly rotates, they may not be “clever lurkers”; they may simply have learned that your team is easy to move. The counter is not necessarily to hunt the lurker. It may be to change your rotation threshold.

4.4. Late-Round Psychology - Time Makes Habits Louder

Under time pressure, decision quality often compresses. Players default to familiar paths, hurry clears, over-focus on the objective, or take desperate duels. This is where previous pattern knowledge becomes especially valuable.

CS2 Example - 18 Seconds Remaining

SITUATION

An attacker has bomb, one teammate alive, and must commit soon. In previous rounds they prefer the shortest path to B when time is low.

What to read: Current map control, last known teammate, utility remaining, and whether you have shown yourself.

Psychology underneath it: Time pressure reduces the number of acceptable options. The player may choose familiarity over creativity because cognitive load is high.

Counter-plan: Hold the highest-probability objective path from a position that avoids giving a free isolated duel. Force them to spend additional seconds clearing you.

Common mistake: Over-rotating early and giving up the alternate site for free.

PART V - LURKING, PEEKING AND ROTATIONS

5.1. Why Does a Player Lurk?

"They lurk" is not enough. Lurking can serve different psychological and strategic purposes. You need to identify which one is likely.

- Punish rotation: the lurker expects defenders to abandon space when teammates create noise.
- Gather information: the lurker wants to hear or see rotations rather than immediately fight.
- Create uncertainty: simply being missing forces defenders to spend attention on the flank.
- Exploit impatience: the lurker expects defenders to push for information.
- Control a timing: the lurker wants to arrive when defenders are looking toward the main hit.
- Personal comfort: some players lurk because they prefer isolated decisions over coordinated entries.

Replay Question - Why Lurk Here?

SITUATION

A high-ELO player stays alone on the opposite side while four teammates pressure A. They do not immediately push.

What to read: What information the main group is creating, what rotations are likely, whether the lurker's job is to kill or simply hold space, and the round economy.

Psychology underneath it: A patient lurker is often manipulating attention. The kill is a consequence, not always the primary goal. Their presence changes what defenders are allowed to do safely.

Counter-plan: When studying the replay, freeze before the lurk pays off and ask: "What defender movement is this position designed to punish?"

Common mistake: Copying the exact lurk position in your games without creating the same pressure elsewhere.

5.2. Why Peek Now?

Every useful replay review should interrogate a peek. Do not ask only "Was the aim good?" Ask what made that second attractive.

- Did a teammate make contact, so the opponent's crosshair was likely elsewhere?
- Did utility expire, creating a short window?
- Did the player hear a reload, scope, step or ability cue?
- Did the clock force the enemy to move?
- Did the player intentionally wait long enough to break the opponent's expected timing?
- Was the peek a trade setup rather than an individual duel?
- Was the player testing whether an earlier pattern still existed?

VALORANT Example - Delayed Re-Peek

SITUATION

A defender is smoked off, waits several seconds after the smoke fades, then peeks instead of peeking immediately.

What to read: What the attacker expects after the smoke disappears and whether they have shifted attention to another threat.

Psychology underneath it: Immediate actions are easiest to anticipate. Delaying can exploit attentional relaxation: the attacker mentally marks the danger as “resolved” and begins processing something else.

Counter-plan: Vary the re-peek timing. If you always swing the instant vision returns, you become mechanically predictable.

Common mistake: Assuming delay is always superior; sometimes the tactical situation demands immediate contact.

5.3. Why Rotate Now?

Rotations reveal a player’s information threshold. Some players rotate on one sound cue. Others wait for spike/bomb confirmation. Some trust teammates instantly; others require visual proof. Learn how much evidence each opponent needs before moving.

Example - The Over-Rotator

SITUATION

Across two rounds, the B anchor leaves after hearing three players at A even though the objective is not seen.

What to read: How quickly they move, whether they leave utility behind, and whether the attacker team has punished the empty site before.

Psychology underneath it: The player may have a high fear of being late to the main fight. That fear makes them easy to manipulate with convincing pressure.

Counter-plan: Show enough information to trigger the rotation, preserve a player on the opposite side, then exploit the space after confirmation.

Common mistake: Executing a fake with no ability to capitalize on the rotation.

PART VI - ECONOMY AS PSYCHOLOGY

6.1. A Purchase Is a Decision About Risk

Weapon buys are not only economy. They reveal how players and teams think about future value, confidence and acceptable risk. When reviewing high-ELO players, always ask: "Why buy this weapon in this round?"

- Is the team maximizing the probability of winning now, or preserving value for the next full buy?
- Does the weapon match the player's intended position or role?
- Are they buying an Operator/AWP because the spawn and map allow an early timing?
- Are they choosing a cheaper rifle to preserve utility?
- Are they force-buying because the opponent's economy is also weak?
- Does the purchase signal confidence, desperation, a planned stack, or a specific tactical call?

CS2 Example - Why Buy a Scout Here?

SITUATION

A high-ELO player buys a Scout rather than a rifle on a limited economy round.

What to read: Spawn, sightline length, enemy armor expectation, team utility, next-round money and whether the player can disengage after a shot.

Psychology underneath it: The purchase may be a controlled risk: preserve economy while creating a high upside opening chance. It can also exploit the opponent's expectation of a weak eco.

Counter-plan: In replay study, connect the weapon to the intended fight. Do not judge the buy before seeing what position the player chooses.

Common mistake: Copying the buy because "a pro did it" without matching the tactical purpose.

VALORANT Example - Operator on Defense

SITUATION

The Jett buys an Operator despite the team having limited credits for utility.

What to read: Defensive spawn, previous enemy pathing, escape ability, enemy anti-Operator habits and whether the team wants to deny a specific lane.

Psychology underneath it: The buy represents concentration of resources into a player expected to convert the weapon into map control, not just kills.

Counter-plan: Ask what space the Operator denies and what teammates can do because that space is denied.

Common mistake: Evaluating the weapon only by K/D instead of map impact.

6.2. Eco Rounds Expose Personality

Low-economy rounds are excellent psychology tests because options are constrained. Some teams become reckless because they feel they have “nothing to lose.” Others become disciplined and seek close-range traps, stacks or utility damage. Record which style appears.

A player who always pushes on eco may be using surprise to compensate for weapon disadvantage. If you know this, your anti-eco plan should prioritize spacing, clearing close positions and refusing unnecessary solo fights.

PART VII - PRESSURE, TILT, CONFIDENCE AND FEAR

7.1. Confidence Changes Risk Perception

Confidence does not simply make aim better. It changes what a player believes is safe. After several successful rounds, players may take wider peeks, skip utility, push deeper or assume opponents will respect them. This is a psychological shift in perceived danger.

Your goal is not to “make them tilted.” Your goal is to notice when emotion changes the probabilities of their decisions.

7.2. Tilt as Predictable Compression

Tilt often compresses a player’s decision tree. Instead of considering five options, they repeat one emotionally satisfying option: revenge peek, chase, solo flank, instant re-buy, or refusal to abandon a duel.

Example - Revenge Re-Peek

SITUATION

You eliminate the same player twice from different defensive angles. Next round they use utility specifically to challenge your area.

What to read: Their path, speed, utility commitment and whether teammates support the play.

Psychology underneath it: The player may be motivated to restore control over the duel. That can make their next action more predictable than usual.

Counter-plan: Change position or let a teammate hold the expected challenge. Make the emotional investment lead into new information.

Common mistake: Taunting or provoking. You do not need harassment to exploit a predictable tactical response.

7.3. Fear and Avoidance

After repeated punishment, some players stop testing a zone entirely. This is also valuable. You may have created psychological map control: they behave as though a location is dangerous even when you are no longer there.

The strongest pressure is sometimes the fight you no longer need to take because the opponent remembers the previous one.

PART VIII - CONDITIONING AND ADAPTATION

8.1. Condition, Confirm, Break

Conditioning is creating an expectation through repeated behavior. The advanced skill is knowing when the expectation is strong enough to exploit.

1. Condition: show the same behavior two or three times when it is strategically reasonable.
2. Confirm: observe whether the opponent begins pre-aiming, rotating, utility-dumping or repositioning against it.
3. Break: change the behavior at a high-value moment.
4. Read the reaction: the opponent's counter becomes new information for the next cycle.

Example - Same Fast A Pressure

SITUATION

Your team pressures A early for three rounds, sometimes committing and sometimes falling back. On round four defenders use early utility and rotate support immediately.

What to read: Utility timing, defender positions, whether mid/B becomes weaker, and whether they are reacting to sound or actual objective confirmation.

Psychology underneath it: You have conditioned the defense to spend resources early because they believe your opening pressure predicts the final hit.

Counter-plan: Show enough pressure to trigger the learned response, then transition before the defenders can recover their structure.

Common mistake: Running the fake when your team has no map control elsewhere.

8.2. Adaptation Speed Is a Skill You Can Read

Some players need one punishment to change. Others repeat the same behavior four times. This "adaptation speed" is itself a trait. Against fast adapters, your pattern may work once. Against slow adapters, you can exploit it longer - but must avoid becoming greedy.

PART IX - FIGHT SELECTION AND TEAM SYNCHRONIZATION

9.1. A Correct Read Is Useless If the Team Cannot Act on It

You can predict the opponent perfectly and still lose if the call is late, unclear or impossible for teammates to execute. Game sense becomes team value only when converted into simple communication.

GOOD COMMS

Evidence + prediction + requested action.

Example: "Their B anchor rotated on first contact twice. Show A pressure, I will hold the B rotation."

Avoid presenting guesses as facts. Say "likely," "I think," or give the evidence. This lets teammates decide how much risk to take on the read.

9.2. Fight Selection Is Psychological Control

If an enemy is mechanically stronger, do not repeatedly give them their favorite fight. Move the problem into timing, utility, numbers, objective pressure or awkward geometry. You are not required to prove superiority in the dimension they prefer.

PART X - THE HIGH-ELO REPLAY

LABORATORY

10.1. Stop Watching Replays Like Entertainment

Watching high-ELO players is one of the fastest ways to improve game sense, but only if you study decisions instead of highlights. The critical habit is to pause before the result and ask why the player chose that action at that exact time.

Do not ask, "What did the high-ELO player do?" Ask, "What problem did they believe they were solving?"

The Rule: Never Copy a High-ELO Action Without Asking Why

When you watch a high-ELO replay, your job is not to collect moves. Your job is to reconstruct the decision. Pause before the action and ask what changed in the previous five to ten seconds.

- Why is this player lurking this round instead of grouping?
- Why do they peek now, not immediately and not five seconds later?
- Why did they choose not to peek even though an enemy might be close?
- Why did they rotate on this amount of information?
- Why did they buy this weapon in this economy?
- Why did they keep or spend utility here?
- What opponent expectation is this action trying to exploit?
- If I copied this exact action in my rank, what condition might be missing?

A replay becomes valuable when you can explain the hidden reason. "He lurked B" is a surface description. "He lurked B because four teammates created A pressure, the B anchor had shown an early rotation threshold, and the lurker wanted to punish that movement without revealing B presence" is game-sense training.

10.2. The Eight Questions to Ask Every Round

1. Why is the player standing here rather than the obvious position?
2. Why did they move now instead of five seconds earlier?
3. Why did they lurk instead of grouping?
4. Why did they peek at this exact moment?
5. Why did they refuse to peek even though an enemy was nearby?
6. Why did they rotate on this information?
7. Why did they buy this weapon and this utility in this economy?
8. What did they expect the opponent to believe?

10.3. The Pause-Before-Action Method

Choose one high-ELO POV or demo and hide the outcome if possible.

Pause immediately before a major decision: peek, rotate, lurk timing, utility use, save, buy or retake.

1. Write what you would do and why.
2. Predict what the high-ELO player will do.

3. Play five to ten seconds.
4. Compare your model to theirs.
5. If they did something different, do not assume they were automatically right. Identify what information or objective you missed.
6. Rewatch the round from the enemy POV when available. This reveals what the decision was designed to manipulate.

10.4. Deep Replay Example - Why Lurk?

Imagine a high-ELO VALORANT player stays B while four teammates make noise toward A. At first, nothing happens. A superficial viewer calls it “baiting.” A useful analysis goes deeper.

- Team pressure at A may force the B defender to rotate.
- The lurker may be controlling the defender’s safest rotation path.
- The lurker may be preserving B access if the A hit fails.
- By staying silent, the lurker denies defenders confirmation that B is empty.
- The lurker may wait until teammate contact consumes attention, then cross a normally dangerous line.
- If no defender moves, the lurker still gains information: the defense may be holding disciplined anchors.

Now ask the psychological question: what does the defender believe? If the defender believes all five attackers are A, they may move. The lurker’s job is partly to create a false model inside the defender’s mind.

10.5. Deep Replay Example - Why Peek?

A high-ELO CS2 player waits behind cover while a teammate fights, then peeks half a second after the first contact. The timing may be designed around attention. The enemy’s crosshair, recoil, movement and working memory are occupied by the first threat. The second player is not merely “trading”; they are attacking an attentional bottleneck.

When reviewing, ask: Was the spacing intentional? Could the second player see the first player’s contact? Was there a sound cue? Did the enemy need to transfer aim? Was the peek late enough to avoid both players dying to the same spray, but fast enough to deny a reset?

10.6. Deep Replay Example - Why Buy This Weapon?

Do not separate economy review from tactical review. If a player buys a shotgun, SMG, Scout, Marshal, AWP or Operator, immediately inspect where they go. The weapon often reveals the intended geometry of the round.

REPLAY ECONOMY QUESTIONS

What fight does this weapon want?
What fight does it avoid?
What range does it control?
What utility had to be sacrificed?
What is the next-round cost if this fails?
Does the enemy expect this purchase?

10.7. Build a Decision Notebook

Create a replay notebook with four columns: Situation, my prediction, High-ELO decision, Principle learned. Over time, you will stop collecting isolated tricks and start discovering recurring principles.

Situation	My prediction	High-ELO decision	Principle learned
4v4, 35 sec, weak B info	Group A	Player holds mid lurk	Preserve option + punish rotation
Smoke fades after no contact	Instant peek	Waits 3 sec then peeks	Break expected timing
Low money, long-range spawn	Save	Buys Scout	Cheap map-control attempt with exit
Enemy shows 3 A early	Rotate immediately	Anchor waits for objective cue	Disciplined information threshold

PART XI - GAME-SPECIFIC APPLICATIONS

11.1. VALORANT - Read Roles, Utility and Ultimate Pressure

VALORANT adds agent roles and ability economy to the psychological model. A player's action is constrained not only by weapon and map, but by available utility and ultimate status.

- If an initiator has key recon utility, ask where the team is likely to spend it and what space they want after it.
- If an entry agent has escape movement, expect risk tolerance to rise at angles where they can disengage.
- If a controller has no smokes, late-round site hits become psychologically harder; defenders can take different risks.
- An ultimate can change the opponent's preferred plant site, retake plan or willingness to save.

11.2. CS2 - Read Spawn, Utility Discipline and Economy

CS2 is extremely sensitive to spawn, utility and economy. The same player may choose a different opening because their spawn gives a faster timing. High-level replay analysis should always consider whether the action was player preference or spawn-enabled opportunity.

11.3. Apex Legends - Read Survival Priorities

In battle royale, the psychological problem expands beyond one enemy team. Position, ring, third-party risk, resources and escape routes change how rational aggression is. A team that looks passive may simply be preserving a superior end-game position.

11.4. Overwatch - Read Cooldown Confidence

Players become aggressive when key cooldowns create temporary safety. Track which enemy becomes brave only when a defensive or mobility ability is available. When that resource is missing, their psychological risk tolerance often collapses.

11.5. League of Legends - Read Tempo, Vision and Habitual Routes

In League, game sense means predicting pathing, recalls, objective setup and pressure distribution. Ask why a player is showing on a wave now, what information that reveals, and which unseen action becomes more likely because of it.

PART XII - THE H.A.N.Z.O. SYSTEM

12.1. H - History

What has this player already shown? Separate raw events from interpretation. Track timings, routes, reactions and success/failure.

12.2. A - Attention

Where is the opponent's attention likely directed? Teammate contact, utility, objective pressure and sound can create moments when attention is overloaded or misallocated.

12.3. N - Need

What does the opponent need right now? A plant, a kill, information, space, survival, weapon preservation, an ultimate point, a trade or simply time. Need removes options.

12.3. Z - Zone

Which locations are possible, valuable or psychologically comfortable? Use timing and map geometry to eliminate impossible zones and identify safe/familiar ones.

12.4. O - Outcome Update

After the result, update immediately. Did they adapt? Did success increase confidence? Did failure create avoidance? Never fight the player they were three rounds ago.

H.A.N.Z.O. IN ONE LINE

History -> Attention -> Need -> Zone -> Outcome update.

PART XIII - 30-DAY TRAINING PROGRAM

Week 1 - Observation Without Prediction

For seven days, your goal is to collect evidence. Do not try to be clever. After each round, identify one repeatable behavior and one thing you are uncertain about.

Day 1 - 7: Record first-contact player, first-contact timing, and one reaction after taking damage.

Week 2 - Timing and Probability

Day 8 - 14: Before a likely contact, state three possible actions and rank them most to least likely. Review whether the reasoning was sound.

Week 3 - Psychological State and Conditioning

Day 15 - 21: Track one opponent across several rounds. Note how success, failure, economy and pressure change their risk tolerance.

Week 4 - Replay Laboratory

Day 22 - 30: Study 20-30 minutes of high-ELO replay. Pause before five major decisions and answer the eight replay questions.

APPENDIX - WORKSHEETS

Round Learning Log

Round	Evidence	Hypothesis	Confidence	Test	Result / Update

High-ELO Replay Study Sheet

1. Why is the player here?

2. Why move now?

3. Why lurk?

4. Why peek now?

5. Why not peek?

6. Why rotate?

7. Why buy this weapon?

8. What does the player expect the enemy to believe?

9. What information changed the decision?

10. What principle can I reuse in another map/game?

Final Message - Learn the Person Behind the Play

The goal of game sense is not to become obsessed with prediction. It is to make uncertainty smaller. You observe. You form a model. You test it. You notice what success, failure, pressure and time do to the person on the other side of the screen. Then you update.

When you watch a high-ELO player, do not copy the surface. Ask why. Why this position? Why this timing? Why the lurk? Why the peek? Why the weapon? Why the rotation? Why did they wait? Why did they suddenly speed up? Those questions train the part of your brain that turns experience into game sense.

The opponent is always telling you a story through their decisions. Your job is to learn how to read it.

Thank you

I also want to thank my mum, dad, sister, my fiancée, and every teammate, opponent, manager, friend, and gaming community I have been part of over the years. Every match, mistake, win, loss, and conversation has helped shape the way I understand game sense today.

I hope this book gives you something useful to take into your own games, and maybe even helps you see the game in a different way.

Keep learning, keep adapting, Stay humble

Good luck in your games, and good luck with whatever you are working toward in the real world too.

And don't forget to step away from the screen sometimes, touch some grass, and enjoy life outside the game. 😊

GLHF <3

--- Supun "Hanzo" Hasanka